
TUNISIAN BACCALAUREAT EXCELLENCE SERIES

ENGLISH REVISION DOSSIER

UNIT 1: ARTS AND HOLIDAYS CHAPTER 2: SPACE TOURISM

Welcome to the ****Ultimate Revision Course & Active Recall Repository**** for Unit 1, Chapter 2 (Space Tourism). This dossier has been specifically optimized for Tunisian high school students preparing for the National Baccalaureate Examination. It integrates exhaustive theoretical reviews, data-driven analytical charts, and an intensive active recall database.

SECTION	HIGH-YIELD REVISION COMPONENT CONTENT
• PART 1	Comprehensive Theoretical Review (Lexicon, Grammatical Formulas, Phonetics, and Stylistic Guides)
• PART 2	The Active Recall Repository (40 exhaustive exam-standard Questions & Answers with detailed rationales)
• PART 3	Diagnostic Exam Evaluation Quiz (QCM, True/False, and highly detailed correction keys)
• REVISION MEMOS	Visual tables synthesizing complex gerund/infinitive rules and negative prefixation metrics

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EXCELLENCE PORTAL FOR HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS

PART 1: EXHAUSTIVE THEORETICAL COURSE

1. Space Tourism: Thematic Overview & Core Lexicon

In Unit 1, Chapter 2, the curriculum transitions from earthly vacations (like the Seychelles) to the futuristic and highly controversial domain of **Space Tourism**. The text explores the transition of spaceflight from military or pure scientific exploration to commercial markets. Key debates focus on high costs (exclusivity for the ultra-wealthy), the physical training involved, and the environmental and physical threats. Baccalaureate essays regularly test students on comparing traditional travel experiences with cosmic exploration, requiring precise vocabulary.

High-Yield Term	Part of Speech	Academic Definition	Exam Translation
Commercialize	Verb	To manage or exploit space flights for corporate profit.	Commercialiser
Well-to-do	Adjective	Wealthy, rich, or affluent; referencing space tourists.	Aisé / Riche
Suborbital	Adjective	A flight that reaches space but falls back without orbiting.	Suborbital
Orbital	Adjective	A flight that completes at least one full orbit of Earth.	Orbital
Cosmic	Adjective	Relating to the universe or outer space; celestial.	Cosmique
Gravity	Noun	The force pulling objects; experienced as 'weightlessness'.	Gravité
Prohibitive	Adjective	So high as to prevent the purchase of something.	Prohibitif
Overview Effect	Noun	Psychological shift from seeing Earth from outer space.	Effet de vue d'ensemble

2. Proverbial Idioms of the Chapter

Idiomatic Phrase	Literal / Metaphorical Meaning	Practical Academic Example Sentence
The sky is the limit	There is no limit to what can be achieved.	With continuous hard work, the sky is the limit for your Bac results.
Reach for the stars	Aim for extremely high, ambitious goals.	My teacher always told me to reach for the stars in my career.
Once in a blue moon	An event that happens extremely rarely.	We only go to expensive luxury resorts once in a blue moon .
Down to earth	Sensible, practical, humble, and realistic.	Despite his massive wealth, the space entrepreneur remains very down to earth .

3. Advanced Grammar: Gerund Patterns & Phrasal Alternations

A cornerstone grammatical structure of this chapter is the **Gerund (-ing)**. Unlike other verbs that take infinitives ('decide to go'), specific verbs of preference, avoidance, and mental processes strictly require a Gerund. Additionally, certain verbs exhibit critical meaning changes when followed by a gerund versus an infinitive.

Verb Category	Verbs Exhibiting Pattern	Syntactic Rule & Example Sentence
Strictly + Gerund	Avoid, Enjoy, Appreciate, Risk, Keep, Mind, Suggest, Postpone, Admit, Deny	Must be followed by a Verb-ing. <i>Example:</i> 'They postponed launching the shuttle.'
Alternating Meaning	Stop (doing) vs. Stop (to do)	Stop + Gerund: Ceasing an action. Stop + Infinitive: Pausing to begin a new action. <i>Example:</i> 'He stopped taking photos' vs 'He stopped to take photos'.
Retrospective Verbs	Remember, Forget, Regret	+ Gerund: Looking back at a past action. + Infinitive: Looking forward to an obligation.

4. Negative Prefixation & Stress Shifts

In English word formation, we use negative prefixes (*un-*, *in-*, *im-*, *ir-*, *il-*, *dis-*, *ab-*, *non-*) to negate meanings. This process has strict orthographic and phonetic rules that are highly tested on Tunisian exams.

Prefix	Orthographic Rule	Root Syllable Accent	Prefixed Word Pronunciation
im-	Used strictly before p, b, m .	POS -sible (1st)	im- POS -sible (2nd syllable)
il-	Used strictly before l .	LE -gal (1st)	il- LE -gal (2nd syllable)
ir-	Used strictly before r .	re- SPON -sible (2nd)	ir-re- SPON -sible (3rd syllable)
un- / in-	General negation rules.	FOR -tu-nate (1st)	un- FOR -tu-nate (2nd syllable)

5. Cost Disparity & Market Horizon Analysis

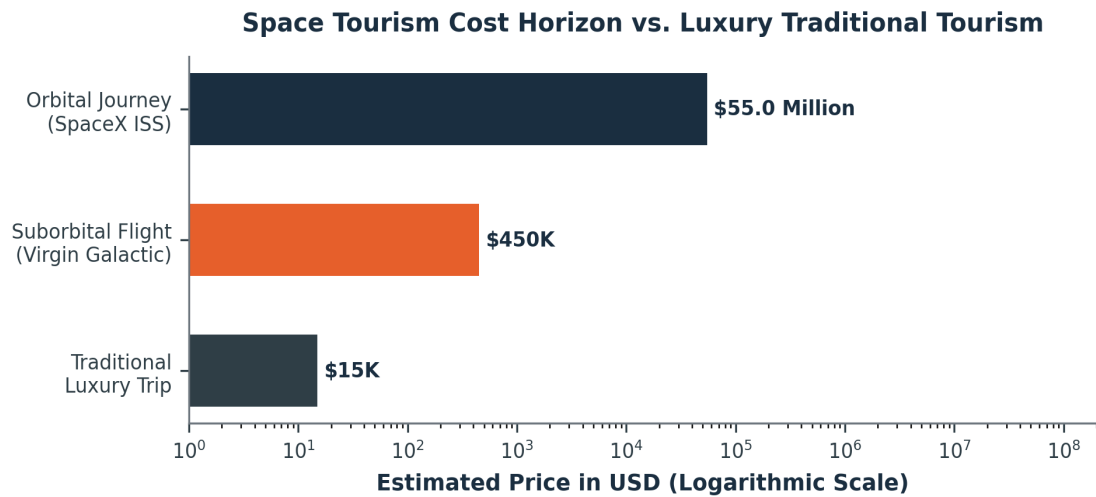


Figure 1.1: Price disparity across traditional high-end vacations, suborbital atmospheric experience, and deep-space orbital missions (Log Scale).

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY – 40 QUESTIONS-ANSWERS

Active Flashcards for Oral & Written Preparation

This repository contains exactly 40 structured questions and answers that cover the entire lexical, grammatical, phonological, and cultural spectrum of Chapter 2. Fold or cover the right column to test your active recall!

Section A: Lexical Range, Definitions & Idioms (Q1 - Q15)

EXAM QUESTION	DETAILED MODEL ANSWER / KEY
Q1: What is the primary difference between suborbital and orbital space tourism?	Suborbital flights reach the edge of space but descend immediately without completing an orbit around Earth (taking about 10-15 minutes). Orbital flights cross higher thresholds, completing full revolutions around Earth and lasting for days (e.g., visits to the ISS).
Q2: Define the term 'commercialize' in the context of outer space travel.	To commercialize space means to transition it from state-funded scientific exploration (NASA/ESA) to profitable, privately operated businesses that offer travel services to commercial customers.
Q3: What does 'well-to-do' mean in the context of the text?	It means wealthy, rich, or affluent. It directly references the targeted customer base for space tourism, as the initial prices are extremely prohibitive for average citizens.
Q4: Define the adjective 'cosmic' and its application in the chapter.	Cosmic relates to the universe or outer space as a distinct physical entity. It is used to describe cosmic experiences, celestial vistas, and cosmic radiation that passengers might encounter.
Q5: What is the meaning of 'gravity' and how does it affect astronauts?	Gravity is the invisible force pulling objects toward Earth. In space tourism, suborbital flights offer a brief window (4-5 minutes) of weightlessness or 'zero-gravity' where tourists float freely.
Q6: Explain the concept of 'the final frontier' as used in modern exploration.	Originally popularized by science fiction, 'the final frontier' refers to outer space as the ultimate unexplored region left for humanity to conquer and settle after mapping Earth's geography.
Q7: What is the exact definition of a 'suborbital flight'?	A suborbital flight is a spaceflight in which the spacecraft reaches outer space but its trajectory intersects the atmosphere or surface of the central body from which it was launched, preventing it from completing an orbit.
Q8: Explain the idiom 'once in a blue moon' with a practical example.	It refers to an event that happens extremely rarely. Example: 'Going to space is so expensive that average people will only do it once in a blue moon.'
Q9: What is the meaning of the idiomatic proverb 'reach for the stars'?	It means to set high, ambitious, or difficult goals. It is a dual-layered idiom in this chapter, signifying both literal stellar travel and metaphorical career ambition.
Q10: Translate and explain the term 'outer space' into French academic context.	It translates to 'l'espace lointain' or 'l'espace extra-atmosphérique'. In essays, it is crucial for discussing the boundary of human habitats and international treaty frameworks.
Q11: Which verb patterns require a Gerund (-ing) instead of an Infinitive? List five.	Verbs of preference, avoidance, and ongoing states require a gerund. Examples include: <i>avoid, enjoy, appreciate, risk, practice, keep, postpone, suggest, resist, and mind.</i>

EXAM QUESTION	DETAILED MODEL ANSWER / KEY
Q12: Explain the syntactic and semantic difference between 'Stop doing' and 'Stop to do'.	Stop doing: To cease an action permanently or temporarily (e.g., 'He stopped smoking' = he quit the habit). Stop to do: To pause a current activity in order to begin a different action (e.g., 'He stopped to smoke' = he interrupted his walk to light a cigarette).
Q13: Does the verb 'admit' take a gerund or an infinitive? Provide an exam-standard sentence.	It takes a gerund. Correct usage: 'The company admitted overestimating the demand for commercial lunar flights.'
Q14: Explain the pattern for 'keep' when expressing a persistent action in the past.	The verb <i>keep</i> is strictly followed by a gerund (-ing) and never an infinitive. Example: 'Engineers kept refining the thermal shielding of the rocket.'
Q15: How do verbs of avoidance like 'avoid' and 'escape' behave syntactically?	They are followed strictly by a gerund to show an active action of avoiding. Example: 'Pilots avoided flying through high-altitude electrical storms.'

Section B: Grammar Patterns, Prefixation & Stress Shifts (Q16 - Q30)

EXAM QUESTION	DETAILED MODEL ANSWER / KEY
Q16: What is prefixation, and how does it change the grammatical category of a word?	Prefixation is the addition of an affix at the beginning of a base word. Unlike suffixation, prefixation in English almost never changes the word class (e.g., adjective 'pure' remains an adjective when prefixed to 'impure'), but it alters semantic meaning (reversal or negation).
Q17: What are the rules governing the use of the negative prefix 'im-'?	The prefix <i>im-</i> is used before root words starting with the bilabial consonants p , b , or m . Examples: <i>possible</i> -> <i>impossible</i> , <i>balance</i> -> <i>imbalance</i> , <i>mature</i> -> <i>immature</i> .
Q18: When do we apply the negative prefix 'il-'? Show three academic examples.	The prefix <i>il-</i> is applied strictly before root words starting with the consonant l . Examples: <i>legal</i> -> <i>illegal</i> , <i>literate</i> -> <i>illiterate</i> , <i>logical</i> -> <i>illogical</i> .
Q19: Under what orthographic condition is the negative prefix 'ir-' used?	It is applied exclusively to root words starting with the consonant r . Examples: <i>responsible</i> -> <i>irresponsible</i> , <i>reversible</i> -> <i>irreversible</i> , <i>relevant</i> -> <i>irrelevant</i> .
Q20: List four standard words that take the negative prefix 'dis-' instead of 'un-' or 'in-'.	Common exam-centric roots taking <i>dis-</i> are: <i>agree</i> -> <i>disagree</i> , <i>approve</i> -> <i>disapprove</i> , <i>honest</i> -> <i>dishonest</i> , <i>obey</i> -> <i>disobey</i> , <i>appearance</i> -> <i>disappearance</i> .
Q21: Explain the phonetic 'Stress Shift' that occurs when negative prefixes are added.	In English, negative prefixes (like <i>un-</i> , <i>im-</i> , <i>il-</i> , <i>ir-</i> , <i>in-</i>) are generally unstressed. The primary stress remains on the stressed syllable of the root word. Examples: POS -sible -> im- POS -sible, LE -gal -> il- LE -gal.
Q22: Is there an exception where the prefix carries secondary or primary stress? Explain.	Yes, in selective nouns or contrasts, the prefix can take secondary stress (denoted by ,), but the core tonic accent remains on the root: ,ir-re- SPON -si-ble. However, for the Baccalauréat, the fundamental rule is that stress remains on the root syllable.
Q23: Write a sentence containing 'risk' followed by the correct verb form.	Example: 'Wealthy travelers risk losing their deposits if they cancel their orbital flight booking late.' (risk + Gerund).
Q24: Rewrite using a gerund: 'It is essential that we avoid to cause damage to the space craft.'	Correct: 'It is essential that we avoid causing damage to the spacecraft.' (Avoid is followed strictly by -ing, never an infinitive).
Q25: Explain prefixation for the root word 'fortunate'. What is the negative form, and where is the stress?	The root 'fortunate' takes the negative prefix <i>un-</i> to form <i>unfortunate</i> . The stress on the root is on the first syllable: FOR -tu-nate. When prefixed, it remains on that syllable: un- FOR -tu-nate.

EXAM QUESTION	DETAILED MODEL ANSWER / KEY
Q26: What are the environmental concerns associated with regular rocket launches for tourism?	Rocket launches release large amounts of soot, carbon dioxide, and nitrogen oxides directly into the stratosphere, contributing to ozone depletion and localized greenhouse effects.
Q27: How does the text describe the psychological effect of seeing Earth from space? What is this called?	It is referred to as 'The Overview Effect'—a cognitive shift experienced by astronauts when viewing Earth from space, realizing its fragility, lack of borders, and unity.
Q28: State three main motives for individuals to pay half a million dollars to go to space.	The primary motives are: seeking unique thrill and weightlessness, the prestige and social status of space travel, and the scientific curiosity of seeing Earth from above.
Q29: What are the primary safety risks associated with commercial space flight?	Key risks include rocket engine malfunction, decompression sickness, extreme G-forces during reentry, solar radiation exposure, and orbital debris impact.
Q30: What role do private aerospace companies play in modern space flight?	Companies like SpaceX, Blue Origin, and Virgin Galactic design, manufacture, and operate launchers. They have drastically lowered launch costs through reusable rocket boosters.

Section C: Cultural Context, Debates & Essay Composition (Q31 - Q40)

EXAM QUESTION	DETAILED MODEL ANSWER / KEY
Q31: Explain the phrase 'down to earth' as an idiomatic contrast to space tourism.	While literal space travel goes high above, the idiom 'down to earth' describes a person or goal that is practical, realistic, humble, and sensible.
Q32: In an argumentative essay on Space Tourism, what are two 'PRO' arguments?	1. It stimulates private technological innovation that benefits Earth (e.g., advanced materials, energy efficiency). 2. It creates a high-tech industry with specialized engineering jobs and raises global scientific interest.
Q33: In the same essay, what are two 'CON' (opponent) arguments?	1. It is an exclusive plaything for the ultra-wealthy that widens social inequality perception. 2. It has an unjustifiably high carbon footprint during an ongoing ecological crisis on Earth.
Q34: List three transition words used to present a counter-argument in writing.	To introduce a contrasting view, students should use: <i>On the other hand</i> , <i>Conversely</i> , <i>However</i> , <i>Nevertheless</i> , or <i>Even so</i> .
Q35: Write a short paragraph of 3 lines comparing traditional luxury cruise ship travel and suborbital space travel.	Traditional cruises offer prolonged relaxation, expansive terrestrial views, and collective socialization over weeks, whereas suborbital space travel offers brief weightlessness, extreme physiological stress, and a cosmic view within mere minutes.
Q36: What are the rules of spelling changes when appending negative prefixes? Are there double consonants?	Yes, double consonants occur when the prefix ends with the same letter the root begins with (e.g., <i>im-</i> + <i>mature</i> -> <i>immature</i> , <i>il-</i> + <i>legal</i> -> <i>illegal</i> , <i>ir-</i> + <i>regular</i> -> <i>irregular</i>). These are phonetic markers for root-preservation.
Q37: Classify these adjectives under their respective negative prefixes: mature, legal, regular, patient.	• im-: immature, impatient • il-: illegal • ir-: irregular
Q38: What is the negative form of 'disclose' and 'appear'? Where does the stress fall?	The negative forms are <i>undisclose</i> or <i>disclose</i> -> <i>close/disclose</i> and <i>appear</i> -> <i>disappear</i> . In <i>disappear</i> , the primary stress falls on the last syllable: dis-ap- PEAR .
Q39: Provide a model thesis statement for an essay discussing space tourism in the Tunisian Baccalaureate.	Thesis: 'Although space tourism drives unprecedented technological breakthroughs and expands human horizons, its extreme environmental footprint and exclusivity make it a highly controversial endeavor.'

EXAM QUESTION	DETAILED MODEL ANSWER / KEY
Q40: Explain why 'Space Tourism' is an oxymoron.	An oxymoron combines contradictory terms. 'Space' historically represents harsh, scientific, military, or uninhabitable environments, whereas 'tourism' represents leisure, comfort, and safety. Combining them emphasizes the extreme nature of the journey.

PART 3: DIAGNOSTIC EVALUATION QUIZ

Test your understanding of the vocabulary, grammar, phonology, and argumentative logic of Chapter 2. Complete the quiz and check the highly detailed correction key below.

Section I: Multiple Choice Questions (MCQ)

1. The commercial company admitted _____ ticket sales after the booster malfunctioned.
A) to postpone B) postponing C) postpone
2. Space tourists have to get used to _____ in microgravity environments during their training.
A) float B) floating C) floated
3. Choose the correct spelling for the negative form of 'responsible':
A) unresponsible B) imresponsible C) irresponsible
4. Which of the following root-prefix pairs exhibits a stress shift in pronunciation?
A) Legal -> Illegal B) Safe -> Unsafe C) Pure -> Impure
5. Complete the sentence: 'We only see rocket launches of this scale once in a _____ moon.'
A) red B) silver C) blue

Section II: True or False with Exam-Standard Justification

6. The verb 'avoid' can be followed by both an infinitive and a gerund without any difference in meaning.
7. 'Stop doing a task' means to pause it temporarily in order to complete a different task.
8. The prefix 'im-' is applied to root words that start with 'l' and 'r'.
9. Suborbital flights complete full orbits around the Earth, lasting for several weeks.
10. In the word 'impossible', the primary phonetic stress shifts from the first syllable to the second syllable.

EXAM CORRECTION KEY & PEDAGOGICAL ANALYSIS

Section I: MCQ Correction Keys

No	Key	Detailed Pedagogical Analysis & Rule Explanation
1	B	The verb admit belongs to the category of verbs that strictly require a gerund (-ing). 'Admit postponing' is the correct syntactic pattern.
2	B	The pattern ' get used to ' expresses progressive adaptation and is always followed by a noun or gerund (-ing). 'Floating' is correct.
3	C	Roots starting with 'r' take the prefix ir- , resulting in <i>irresponsible</i> with a double 'r'.
4	A	LE-gal (stress on 1st syllable) becomes il-LE-gal (stress on 2nd syllable). The other options maintain the exact root syllable stress position.
5	C	The idiom is ' once in a blue moon ', which represents highly rare and exceptional events.

Section II: True/False Justification Keys

No	Key	Model Written Justification for Baccalaureate Exams
6	FALSE	Verbs of avoidance such as ' avoid ' are strictly followed by a gerund (-ing), never by an infinitive.
7	FALSE	' Stop doing ' means to permanently or temporarily terminate the action, whereas 'stop to do' represents pausing to begin another action.
8	FALSE	The prefix ' im- ' is exclusively used before words starting with the bilabial consonants p, b, and m .
9	FALSE	Suborbital flights do not orbit Earth; they reach the boundary of space and immediately begin descent in an arc trajectory.
10	TRUE	In POS-sible , stress is on the first syllable. In im-POS-sible , the stress shifts to the second syllable (the first of the root).

TUNISIAN BACCALAUREAT EXCELLENCE MEMOS

Memo 1: Verb Pattern Synthesis Chart (Gerund vs. Infinitive)

Grammar Structure	Verbal Syntax	Semantic Nuance & Key Function	Exam Blueprint Sentence
Verb + Gerund	Verb + [V-ing]	Expresses action in general, preference, state or avoidance.	Engineers avoid wasting critical fuel during initial ascent.
Verb + Infinitive	Verb + [to + V]	Expresses decisions, plans, future obligations, or intent.	They decided to launch the orbital mission next week.
Stop doing	Stop + [V-ing]	To terminate or cease an activity permanently or temporarily.	She stopped taking G-force training after feeling dizzy.
Stop to do	Stop + [to + V]	To pause a current task to start a completely different task.	The flight crew stopped to inspect the auxiliary fuel tank.

Memo 2: Prefixation Rules and Stress Shifts Reference Sheet

Negative Prefix	Phonetic Condition	Root Stress	Prefixed Stress	Academic Reference Pairs
im-	Before p, b, m	POS -sible	im- POS -sible	impatient, balance/imbalance
il-	Before l	LE -gal	il- LE -gal	illegible, logical/illogical
ir-	Before r	re- SPON -sible	ir-re- SPON -sible	irrational, regular/irregular
dis- / un-	Varies	ap- PROVE	dis-ap- PROVE	disapprove, unhelpful, unequal

CRITICAL EXAM TIP: When writing an essay, use at least two idioms ('reach for the stars', 'once in a blue moon') and apply proper contrast transition words ('while', 'whereas', 'however') to automatically increase your written expression band score to the maximum.